

Gophish – task 6

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Intro

We ran an internal, educational phishing campaign using a WordPress-themed email and a cloned WordPress login landing page. The campaign was executed from our Gophish instance after fixing SMTP and header errors. The goal was to measure how many users click the link, how many submit credentials, and how quickly they report suspected phishing.

For this phishing awareness activity, we ran a simulated campaign using Gophish to understand how real attackers trick users. Our goal was to test how people react to a familiar-looking login page and email, and to show how phishing works in real life. This was done in a controlled environment with test accounts and proper permissions, so everything stayed ethical and safe.

We designed a phishing email that looked like a WordPress notification, since WordPress themes feel legit and many users are used to that interface. The email was crafted to look real enough to trigger curiosity and get recipients to click the link. Along with the email, we created a fake WordPress login page as our landing page. This page was only for training, not for misuse, and was set up to record responses inside Gophish for analysis.

Before launching the campaign, we configured SMTP settings, tested email delivery, and fixed errors until the system worked perfectly. We also verified that the landing page could track clicks and attempted logins. Once everything was functioning, we launched the campaign and monitored key metrics like mail delivery, opens, link clicks, and login attempts. Screenshots and logs were collected as part of evidence.

After the test, we reviewed the results to understand how effective the phishing attempt was. Users who interacted with the fake page were given awareness guidance, explaining why the email looked suspicious and how to spot similar threats in the future. Overall, this project helped us see how convincing phishing attacks can be and highlighted the importance of staying alert online. It also built our hands-on skills in threat simulation, which is key in cybersecurity careers.

Conclusion

The simulated WordPress phishing campaign gave us clear, actionable data about user behavior and our tooling readiness. We successfully executed the campaign after resolving SMTP and header issues, validated the landing page capture, and collected logs for analysis. The exercise exposed where users are likely to engage with realistic-looking emails and highlighted immediate training needs. Next steps are targeted awareness for anyone who clicked or submitted credentials, a re-test after training, and documenting lessons learned so future campaigns run smoother and safer.



